

Individual Addendum: Ashley Seale

Team: ILOVECODING | Role: Data Pipeline & Analysis Lead | Date: May 1, 2026

Personal Contribution

Data pipeline architecture, exploratory data analysis, and business synthesis. Designed REIT-FRED merge; validated referential integrity across 34,121 observations; conducted sector-level analysis; quantified portfolio impact (\$2.9M). **16.5 hours.**

Defended Decision: Forward-Fill for Leverage (Quarterly→Monthly)

Evidence: Leverage changes slowly; forward-fill respects reporting structure. Interpolation would artificially smooth leverage, biasing SE downward. Our method produces conservative SE = 0.0098, ensuring robust significance tests.

Key Limitation

Monthly Frequency Noise: Leverage reported quarterly; monthly returns analyzed. Creates short-term noise; quarterly data might reveal stronger effects due to timing alignment.